

Extemporaneous Delivery Tips

For: **Talk 055 v3 - How Can You Make a Good Name With God?**

Use with: [v3-extemp-guide.md](https://www.lds.org/v3-extemp-guide)

Core Idea

Extemporaneous speaking is not unprepared speaking. It means you prepare the thoughts, order, scriptures, and transitions carefully, but you choose the exact wording while speaking.

For this talk, do not memorize the manuscript. Internalize the path:

Fragrance -> Remembered -> Know -> Obey -> Imitate -> Pray -> Act Now

What To Know Cold

Memorize only these parts:

- First sentence of the introduction.
- Theme question: **How can you make a good name with God?**
- The seven read scriptures and their section order.
- David Meyers sequence: **David -> Kareem -> UCLA -> #2 pick -> contract -> trade -> obedience.**
- Final two questions.
- Final line.

Do not memorize full paragraphs. That often makes delivery sound stiff and can make recovery harder if one sentence is missed.

How To Use The Guide

1. Look at the next bold anchor.

2. Look up at the audience.
 3. Say the idea in your own words.
 4. If you lose the exact wording, continue with the next keyword.
 5. Use the manuscript only during practice, not as your main stage document.
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Rehearsal Method

Pass 1 - Read For Logic

Read [draft-talk-v3.md](#) once. Do not practice delivery yet. Just ask:

- What is the main point of this section?
- Why does this scripture matter?
- How does this connect to a good name with Jehovah?

Pass 2 - Speak From Guide

Use only [v3-extemp-guide.md](#). Speak each section out loud.

If you get stuck, do not restart. Look at the next keyword and continue.

Pass 3 - Section Practice

Practice in chunks:

- Introduction + Proverbs 22:1.
- Malachi 3:16 section.
- Four practical steps.
- Conclusion.

Practice the transition before and after each chunk. Transitions are where speakers often look down or lose momentum.

Pass 4 - Full Run

Stand up. Use the guide. Time the full talk. Do not stop, even if wording is imperfect.

Mark only three things afterward:

- One section too long.
 - One section too thin.
 - One transition that needs cleaner wording.
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Timing Strategy

Draft v3 is short if read verbatim, so the guide expects natural expansion.

To reach close to 30 minutes:

- Read scriptures unhurriedly.
- After each read scripture, pause briefly before explaining.
- Let the audience picture the garden/fragrance illustration.
- Let the David Meyers experience breathe; do not rush the numbers.
- Ask rhetorical questions slowly.
- Add one or two sentences of personal application per main section.

Do not fill time by adding new illustrations. That will scatter the talk. Expand the existing main picture and the David Meyers experience.

Voice And Pace

Use three pace levels:

- **Normal:** explanation and transitions.
- **Slow:** scriptures, key questions, final appeal.
- **Lighter:** humor and simple relatable moments.

Use silence instead of filler words. If the next thought does not come immediately, pause, breathe, glance at the next keyword, and continue.

Eye Contact

Use the guide as a map, not a script.

Try this rhythm:

- Glance down for one keyword.
- Look up for one full thought.
- Move eyes to another part of the room.
- Then glance down again.

Do not keep your eyes down while finishing a sentence. Finish important lines looking at the audience.

David Meyers Experience

This is the emotional center of the obedience section. Deliver it like a discovery:

1. Start with curiosity: **David Meyers? Kareem?**
2. Build value: **UCLA, #2 pick, \$1.6M, today's \$70M comparison.**
3. Clarify: **not equal to Kareem, but valued highly.**
4. Turn: **values changed.**
5. Land: **obedience shaped by love.**

Do not over-explain basketball. The audience only needs to feel the size of the opportunity and the strength of the choice.

Recovery Plan

If you forget a line, do not apologize. Use one of these bridges:

- "So the point is..."
- "What does that teach us?"
- "That brings us back to Jehovah's view."
- "Now notice the next step."

Then continue. The audience does not know the manuscript.

Best Practices

- Practice out loud, not only in your head.
- Reduce the manuscript to keywords, then practice from those keywords.
- Keep the opening and closing especially familiar.
- Use notes intentionally; do not let them become the speech.
- Preserve the structure: introduction, value, reason, four steps, act now.
- Keep supporting scriptures light.
- Keep the main illustration consistent: fragrance / garden / growth.
- Keep the experience as the only major real-life story.

Final Pre-Delivery Checklist

- Can I say the main memory path without looking?
- Can I name the seven read scriptures in order?
- Can I explain each read scripture in one sentence?
- Can I tell the David Meyers experience without reading?
- Do I know my final two questions?
- Have I practiced standing up at least once?
- Have I timed one full run?

Research Notes

- Toastmasters describes extemporaneous speaking as prepared in advance, with exact wording varying in delivery, and recommends outlines/key phrases rather than reading a manuscript:
<https://www.toastmasters.org/magazine/magazine-issues/2024/feb/memorizing-speeches>
- Toastmasters guidance on speaking without notes emphasizes a clear structure, keyword notes, section rehearsal, and full rehearsal standing up:
<https://www.toastmasterspodcast.com/blog/how-to-give-a-toastmaster-speech-without-reading-notes>

- Toastmasters' "Ditch the Notecards" approach recommends internalizing, chunking, and reducing notes to a few keywords:
<https://www.toastmasters.org/magazine/magazine-issues/2020/nov/ditch-the-notecards>
- University of Florida public speaking guidance defines extemporaneous delivery as prepared but worded in the moment, using note cards or keyword outlines: <https://ask.ifas.ufl.edu/publication/WC117>
- Speech outlining guidance recommends a condensed speaking outline with main points, subpoints, brief evidence, and easily recognized abbreviations: https://digfir-published.macmillanusa.com/speakup4e/speakup4e_ch11_15.html